

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

2026-10-01 · Evening edition · Issued 20:00 CDT

U.S. sends third carrier group to the Middle East

- The Pentagon is sending a third aircraft-carrier strike group and additional Marine Corps ships to the Middle East, adding 9,000 to 10,000 more troops to the region as President Trump considers renewing strikes on Iran after the midterm elections. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The aircraft carrier USS Theodore Roosevelt left San Diego on Sunday, while the USS Makin Island Amphibious Ready Group, carrying Marines from the 13th Marine Expeditionary Unit, left on Monday; the forces will arrive by the end of November. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Two carriers, the USS George H.W. Bush and USS George Washington, are already in the Middle East, and a third staying in the region would mark the first three-carrier presence since April. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The deployments come days after Trump rejected Iran's latest proposal for a seven-day ceasefire, and in a Time magazine interview published Thursday he said he could resume striking Iran after the midterms if there is no deal. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Iran readies harder retaliation if attacked

- Iran is preparing a broader and more forceful response if the United States resumes large-scale military attacks, while continuing a diplomatic push that Iranian officials privately see as unlikely to succeed. — [Reuters](#)
- Senior commanders are reviewing plans to expand potential targets beyond U.S.-linked assets to countries that support U.S. military operations and possibly to locations outside the Middle East, according to three senior Iranian officials and an insider familiar with the discussions. — [Reuters](#)
- No final decision has been made, but planning has intensified since President Masoud Pezeshkian returned from New York last week, as neither side shows signs of willingness to compromise. — [Reuters](#)
- Two of the officials said Tehran had instructed allied groups in Lebanon, Yemen and Iraq to be ready to support Iran in the event of a renewed large-scale U.S. attack. — [Reuters](#)

U.S. sanctions target Iran's auto and rail sectors

- The Trump administration on Thursday imposed fresh sanctions on Iran, targeting its rail and automotive conglomerates and international suppliers to the sectors, in the latest U.S. push to isolate Tehran economically. — [Reuters](#)
- The sanctions are part of the department's "Operation Economic Outcast," announced August 24, which aims to cut Tehran's funding for the war, missile construction, cyberattacks and the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps. — [Reuters](#)
- The U.S. blockade of Iranian oil through the Strait of Hormuz has forced Tehran to rely more on autos and rail for transporting petroleum, fertilizer, chemicals and other goods, and Thursday's sanctions target those alternatives. — [Reuters](#)

- Treasury designated Iran Khodro Company and SAIPA, which together represent more than 90 percent of Iran's domestic auto market, as well as the state-owned Islamic Republic of Iran Railway Company and other rail firms. — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Brent crude settled at \$102.41 a barrel on October 1, gaining 4.4 percent as the U.S. sent another aircraft carrier to the Middle East. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- WTI crude settled at \$92.95 a barrel on October 1, up 2.7 percent on the carrier deployment and renewed strike speculation. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The U.S. national average diesel price fell to \$6.382 a gallon for the week ending September 28, down from the \$6.529 record the prior week, per EIA data. — [Reuters](#)
- UK NBP day-ahead natural gas priced at 178.0 pence per therm on October 1, amid tight storage and prolonged LNG disruption fears. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

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Tankers transiting the Strait of Hormuz (file photo) — [view original](#)

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